



Operational base

The USS *Coral Sea* waits on Yankee Station, an area used as a naval “base” in the Gulf of Tonkin. This aircraft carrier launched many of the aircraft that seeded mines at the entrance to Haiphong Harbor from May 1972.

“We want to **strike** in a fashion that **maximizes their difficulties.**”

HENRY KISSINGER TO US AMBASSADOR ELLSWORTH BUNKER, MAY 6, 1972

» AFTER

The Paris Accords committed the United States to clearing the mines from Haiphong Harbor.

ASSESSING THE IMPACT

The CIA estimated that North Vietnam’s **imports** in June and July 1972 fell to about 3,000 tons a day, less than half the 6,100 ton daily level of the previous year, but still more than the estimated daily requirements of 2,700 tons.

OPERATION END SWEEP

The need to clear the mines became a **bargaining chip** during the **Paris peace negotiations**. Eventually, it was agreed that the US would take responsibility for removing the mines. This was undertaken by the US Navy’s Mine Warfare Service in an operation codenamed **End Sweep** between February and July 1973.